

## Writing Identity in Language Prelims Paper 1: Week 3 HANDOUT

COLSTON '**TOPPLERS**' GET **SLAP ON WRISTS**: FIVE BLM  
ACTIVISTS QUIZZED AFTER SLAVE TRADER'S STATUE **WAS**  
**DUMPED** IN BRISTOL HARBOUR ARE LET OFF WITH POLICE  
CAUTIONS

- The **bronze** statue of the slave trader was **toppled and dumped** in Bristol's docks during the Black Lives Matter protests in June
- The chief constable of Avon and Somerset Police says five people interviewed over **the incident** will be offered conditional cautions
- He proposed they '**pay a fine and do some acts to make good their crime**'

By [Antonia Paget For Mailonline](#) Published: 18:02, 17 September 2020

Five people interviewed over the toppling of a statue of slave trader Edward Colston in Bristol will be offered conditional cautions, a chief constable has said.

The **bronze memorial** to the 17th century **slave merchant** was **pulled down** during a [Black Lives Matter](#) protest on June 7, before **being dumped** in Bristol Harbour.

No **arrests** were made at the time but officers reviewed CCTV footage and other pictures and video to identify 18 people they wanted to speak to. Andy Marsh, chief constable of Avon and Somerset Police, said eight people had been interviewed and one person had been arrested on suspicion of causing criminal damage to the statue.

'The law was broken, it was an act of criminal damage,' the chief constable told BBC Radio Bristol on Thursday.

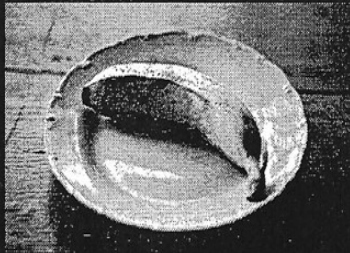
'Fortunately, as far as I'm concerned, it was one crime, one act of damage in an event that carried a significant amount of risk for Bristol and the community.'

1 ***New York Times*, 12 June 2020.**

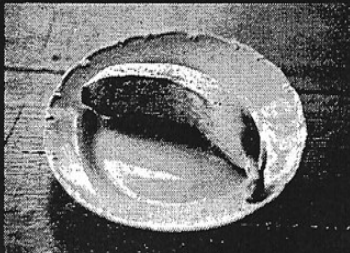
2 BRIGHTON, England — Tens of thousands of people protested in British cities  
3 in solidarity with those rising up against police brutality against black  
4 Americans in the past week. They highlighted similar [injustices in Britain](#).  
5 Protesters in the city of Bristol drew connections between a white police  
6 officer's killing of George Floyd, a black man in Minneapolis, and the histories  
7 of colonialism and the slave trade. On Sunday, they [toppled the statue of](#)  
8 [Edward Colston](#), a 17th-century slave trader, trampled over it and rolled it into  
9 Bristol Harbor.

10 Between 1672 and 1689, Colston's Royal African Company shipped about  
11 100,000 enslaved people from West Africa to the Americas and the Caribbean,  
12 branding them on their chests with his corporation's acronym, RAC. Disease  
13 and dehydration killed more than 20,000 people taken onto those ships by  
14 Colston's company, and their bodies were thrown into the ocean. Yet Colston's  
15 bronze statue, which was erected in 1895 in Bristol, was engraved with the  
16 inscription “... one of the most virtuous and wise sons” of the city.

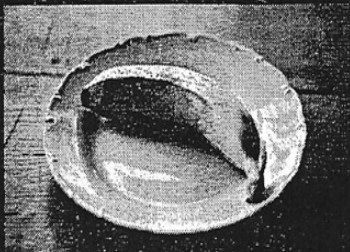
17 Toppling statues is one way of unsettling accounts of the past that fail to  
18 acknowledge the [broader truths of the British Empire](#). Attempts had been made  
19 through petitions and letters and engagements with local authorities to change  
20 the inscription and to reconsider the names of civic and public institutions that  
21 continued to honor him. But to no avail. This week, people of all backgrounds  
22 joined together to highlight the multiple injustices embodied in the statue and  
23 took matters into their own hands.



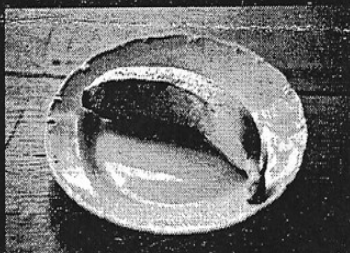
Banana



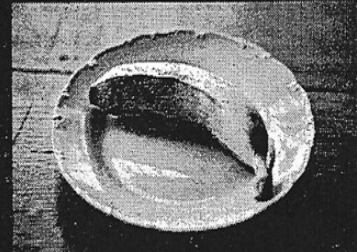
Vitamins



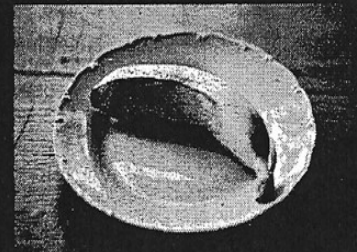
Slapstick comedy



Sexual innuendo



Trade wars



Racist weapon

If you take things only at face value,  
you could miss what is important.

WHAT'S IMPORTANT  

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THE  TIMES